

Case Study: Improving Alignment Between Strategy, Product, and Delivery

1. Context

This model highlights the importance of connecting systems that are often applied independently.

In many organizations, product teams operate efficiently in isolation, but struggle to align with broader strategic goals.

Common challenges include:

- Strategy defined at a high level but not connected to execution
- Product teams focused on delivering outputs
- Improvement efforts that are reactive rather than systematic

This case study demonstrates how the **Product Operating System (POS)** can be applied to address these challenges.

2. Problem

The organization faced three core issues:

1. **Misalignment between strategy and product work**
Teams were delivering features without a clear connection to strategic objectives
2. **Lack of outcome visibility**
Success was measured in delivery output rather than customer or business outcomes
3. **No structured improvement loop**
Retrospectives existed, but no systemic way to prioritize improvements

3. Approach

The Product Operating System was introduced in three steps:

Step 1: Establish a Single Backlog

The biggest impact came from simplifying decision-making through a single backlog and structured prioritization. All sources of work were unified into one system:

- Product features
- Customer insights
- Strategic initiatives (OKRs)
- Improvement actions

This becomes the **single source of execution**

Step 2: Align Strategy to Execution

Strategy was translated into **OKRs**, which then informed:

- Prioritization decisions
- Backlog refinement
- Product team focus

Step 3: Introduce a Structured Improvement Loop

A quarterly improvement cycle was implemented:

Assess → Analyze → Identify → Prioritize → Improve

Inputs included:

- Delivery metrics
- Product outcomes
- Assessment frameworks

Outputs:

- Improvement backlog items
- Prioritized initiatives

4. Solution Model

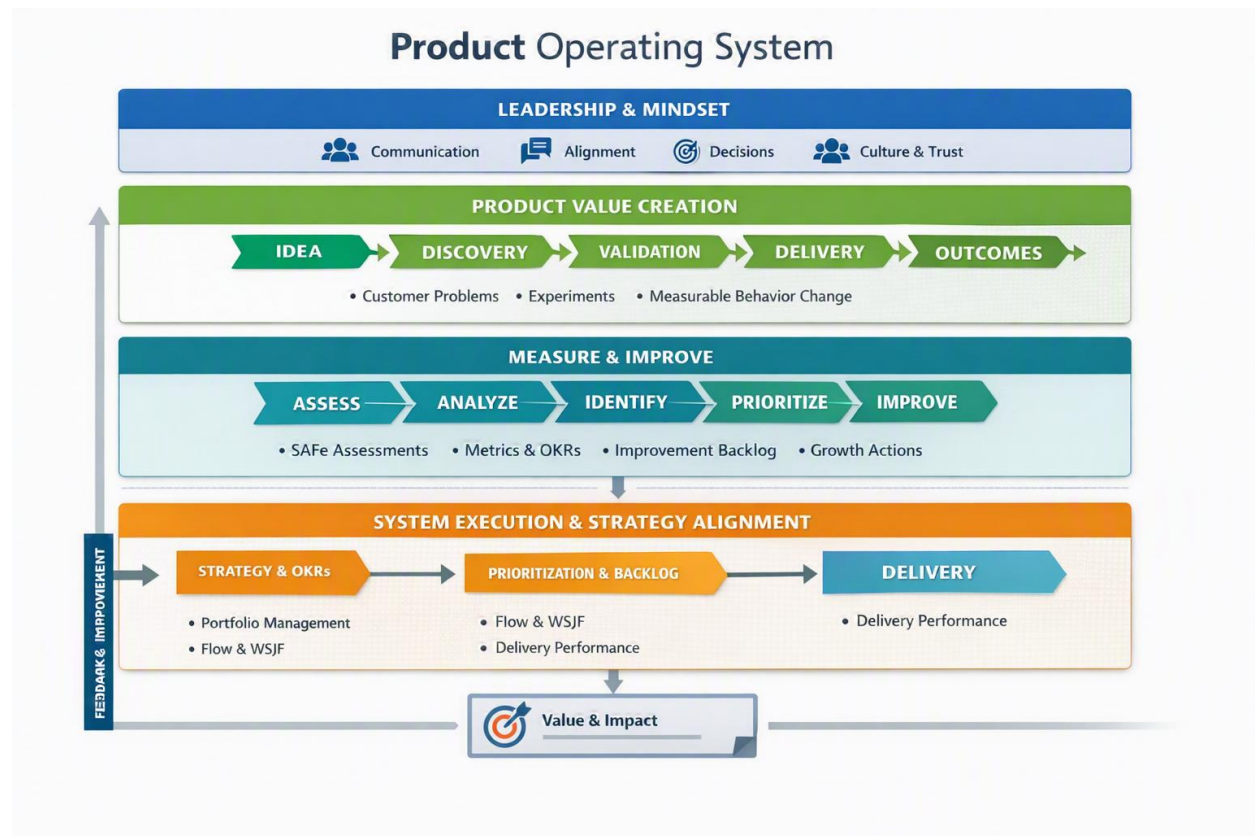


Figure 1: Product Operating System Architecture

5. Outcomes

After applying this model:

- ☒ Improved alignment between product work and strategic objectives
- ☒ Clear prioritization based on outcomes, not output
- ☒ Increased visibility into delivery and product performance
- ☒ Structured approach to continuous improvement

6. Key Takeaways

- A single backlog is critical for alignment
- Strategy must be translated into actionable priorities
- Continuous improvement requires structure, not ad hoc effort
- Integrating systems is more effective than adding frameworks